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Methodology protocol

Workpackage 5, 6 & 7

Part of D5.1, D6.1, D7.1

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MiCREATE

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1. Introduction to methodological protocol

Methodological Protocol guides the MiCREATE project and consortium in the design, planning and implementation of its tasks in relation to:

- planning and implementing research activities in schools:
- detailed information and guidelines on the interventions to be made, procedures to be used, measurements to be taken, observations to be made;
- focus of the research identifying and resolving issues of ethical concern in relation to the overall methodological framework of the study;
- clarification of all aspects of the study;

The Methodological Protocol ensures that all partners and national teams are aware of and comply with the planned research activities and interventions. The MP is a working document and will be recurrently reviewed in line with the research design, implementation and dissemination activities during the project.

2. The rationale of the fieldwork with children

MiCREATE project aims to study integration processes from a child-centred perspective. A child-centred approach is a participatory approach that recognizes children as active participants within the social interactions and as autonomous individuals able to communicate information about their own lives and thus provide a valid source of data. The main feature of the child-centred approach is in shifting the focus from the dominant adult-centric perspective on child experiences to 'putting the children first', in taking children as experts of their own lives, skilful communicators, right-holders and meaning-makers, as well as in seeing them as actors and knowers, able to speak for themselves. In other words, a child-centric approach seeks to reduce common-sense adult-centred explanations in order to facilitate childhood agency in various fields and challenges the dominant discourse about whose knowledge counts. For more information on common ground for all partners, please see our report Child-centered approach across disciplines, available in Moodle.[1]

This suggests that in ethnographic research we can approach children just as any other social group has been studied by anthropologists. Our research will respect their perspective not to lose the trail of their "children" or "youth" culture. We will strive to enter the cognitive landscapes of children, including talk, behaviours, beliefs and attitudes, without imposing our adult values. On the other hand,

[1] https://moodle.zrs-kp.si/moodle/pluginfile.php/820/mod_resource/content/1/D2.6%20Child-centred%20Approach%20Across%20Disciplines_report_DRAFT_v02.pdf

we will attempt to grasp children's understanding of migration and integration processes, e.g. how migrant children perceive host societies, how migrant children adapt their lives to present conditions in terms of their own ethnic and cultural symbols and values, how local children perceive their peers from foreign countries etc.

3. Research questions

MiCREATE project aims to study integration processes from a child-centered perspective. In the broadest and most basic sense, integration means 'the process by which people who are relatively new to a country (i.e. whose roots do not reach deeper than two or three generations) become part of society'; it is a 'process of settlement, interaction with the host society, and social change that follows immigration' (Penninx and Garcés-Mascareñas, 2016: 11) . Following this characterisation, two main research questions of our fieldwork are:

- How (migrant and local) children perceive and experience the processes of migrant integration?
- How educational staff approach and addresses migrant integration processes?

4. Objectives of the fieldwork research in schools

The overall objective is to gain comprehensive knowledge about the processes of migrant integration in host societies, focusing on newly arrived migrant children, long term residents and local children. The study gives special emphasis on examining the integration of these children in relation to diverse factors and variables, including age, gender, religion, ethnic backgrounds and socioeconomic status. The **general objectives** of the fieldwork are:

- to assess factors influencing the integration process of migrant children such as living conditions, inclusion in peer groups, involvement in leisure activities, sport, presence/absence of strong ethnic community, the role of the local environment, spatial and social positioning, etc.
- to examine the conceptualizations of well-being and what is important to them in **their present situation** (in relation to living conditions, socioeconomic status, cultural background, gender, religion, language proficiency, etc.) and to learn how children prioritize their needs
- to examine migrant children's satisfaction with their new life in the host society through their self-perceived opportunities, choices and feeling of control over their own life and future, their identification and belonging.

- to identify the advantages and weaknesses of existing models of migrant children's integration and to assess their experiences and views regarding the shortcomings of integration support services
- to observe the dynamics of integration in relation to educational systems, peer group, sport, leisure activities, psychosocial support services, language learning courses; and in relation to the dynamics of family and migrant community
- to explore local children's perceptions, values, attitudes and opinions regarding equality, intercultural dialogue, intercultural conflicts, cultural and religious pluralism, migrants and migration.

Objectives related to specific workpackages:

Workpackage 5: Newly Arrived Migrant Children

- to improve our understanding of the children's experiences of life in new social and cultural environments related to the arrival and staying in host societies within the first three years after arrival from a child-centred perspective.

Workpackage 6: Long-term Resident Migrant Children

- to improve our understanding about how migrant children with long-term residency have experienced integration in host societies, how are they satisfied with their new life, what are their needs and future ambitions, to get insight into their 'strategies' of inclusion which they employed after coming to new social environments

Workpackage 7: Local Children

- to capture the nature of the integration processes from local children's perspective and explore how local children and peer groups can be involved in the more successful integration of newly arrived migrant children

Workpackage 10: Integration Lab

- to collect necessary data and prepare starting points for Integration Lab (WP10).

Workpackage 11: Policy Lab

- to collect necessary data and prepare starting points for Policy Lab (WP11)

5. General overview of methodological approach

Research in schools will be conducted over several stages with an overall duration of 9 months and will employ variety of methods. One of the challenges of doing research with children is that it is impossible to treat them as homogenous group. Their differences will manifest, most notably in relation to age, but also ethnicity, gender and social class. In our research, we will focus on two age groups, that is preadolescents (10-13-year-olds) and middle adolescents (14-17-year-olds).

Newly arrived migrants: migrant children, who have been living in host countries for less than three years within two age groups (10–13 y and 14–17 y).

Long term residents: migrant children, who have been residing in host country for more than five years within two age groups (10–13 y and 14–17 y).

Local children: children, who have been born in the country (10–13 y and 14–17 y).

The fieldwork research with children in schools will start with **participant observation** as a way of 'entering the field', which will **enable the using of the information gained from observing through explicit recording (taking fieldnotes).** This will give an insight into migrant integration processes and peer dynamic within the context in which it occurs.

The research will go on by using **participatory art-based** methods (the protocol for art-based approach will be added in later stages of the research),[2] **interviews** with students (collection of **autobiographical life stories** and in part the method of **narratives of location**). These methods were chosen with the aim to give children a central position and, in line with child-centered approach, to take them as the main source of information.

In schools we will also implement **focus groups** with children (newcomers, long-term resident and local), which will, unlike an interview, allow members of the group to interact and influence each other during the discussion and consideration of ideas and perspectives.

Fieldwork research also includes conducting a **survey** as a means to collect quantitative data. In the sample, all children will be involved; however, the interpretation of data will take into account the variable of migration status. Survey will collect information about measurable indicators of migrant inclusion in host societies, such as school success (academically, socially or both), inclusion in peer group, sport, leisure activities, extracurricular activities, family and migrant community dynamics and similar. We will seek to apply more explorative approach that would aim at understanding well-being

[2] According to annex 1 (project description) we have planned to apply Mosaic approach (Clark and Moss, 2005; Clark and Moss, 2011), which recognizes different 'voices' or languages of children and combines the traditional methodology of observation and interviewing with the introduction of participatory tools (drawing, writing, taking photographs, film short movies and/or do other arts activities). However, use of art-based approaches will be adopted to children age and used only if deemed reasonable.

in the eyes of the children, asking what well-being looks like to them and do they, according to their understanding, have a sense of well-being.

6. Projected timeframe of the research activities

	Activity	Timeframe	Brief description of activity
		2019	
4	Selection of the classes involved in the survey	September 2019	Between 1 and 3 class, depending on size and cultural diversity.
5	Signing a consent by parents	September 2019	Parents of children in selected classes (1 - 3) receive written information about the survey and all explanations regarding children's participation, anonymity, data usage. Cooperation is voluntary.
5	Participant observation	October – December 2019	Participant observation spans over 15 days (non-consecutively, in class, during breaks, after school, in corridors, excursion, etc.). Researchers can (if desired) organize activities.
		2020	
7	Survey with children	January / February 2020	The questionnaire can be completed in a computer classroom in electronic form or in written form during a class hour (approximately 1 hour).
8	2 focus groups with children	January – May 2020	6-8 Participants in focus group, measuring how children perceive cultural diversity, integration, intercultural coexistence, etc.
9	Interviews with children	January – May 2020	Individual interviews with local children (5), newly immigrated children (5), long term residents (5).
10	Analysis of data	May – September 2020	

7. Participant observation

Participant observation is a method, which will allow us to take part in the daily activities, rituals, interactions, and events of a children as one of the means of learning the explicit and tacit aspects of their life routines and their "culture" (see e.g. Fine and Sandstrom, 1999, Pellegrini, Hoch, and Symons, 2013; DeWalt, and DeWalt, 2011). The main aim of participant observation is to understand the migrant integration processes in context. By applying the method of participant observation, we aim to collect data in school settings, which is one of the places where migrant integration occurs, by observing and taking part in school activities.

The method of participant observation includes the use of the information gained from participating and observing through explicit recording and analysis. It requires a particular approach to the recording of observations (in fieldnotes), which are collected through participation and treated

equally important to social scientific analysis as information from more formal research techniques such as interviewing, structured observation, and the use of questionnaires and formal elicitation techniques.

7.1 Why participant observation?

Participant observation will be a way of approaching the migrant integration experience and gaining understanding of the related processes of social life. It will provide context later stages of the research, including sampling, open-ended interviewing, construction of interview guides and questionnaires, and other more structured and more quantitative methods of data collection. Through participant observation we will:

- develop rapport with the children, teachers and other educational staff, who play important roles in the process of integration in school environment, which will have implications for the feasibility of data collection over 9 months.
- develop specific premises about the integration of migrant children in specific situations. The preliminary observation period will enable to specify, more exactly, the question guiding the research.
- get an understanding of the setting and dynamics within the context in which social interactions related to migrant integration occur, including peer dynamic and relationship between students and teachers, knowledge of day-to-day activities in school community, school organisation, etc.
- get an insight into (non)existence of child-centered approaches in classrooms and everyday school environments.
- assess the multiculturality in educational practices and school environment.

7.2 Building trust with school personnel

Our research and observations will be in someone else's territory, that is why it is essential that we establish good relationship with key school personnel and to become familiar with them. Educational staff, in our case it may be the headmaster, counselling workers, teachers or other profiles, may be viewed as "gatekeepers," because they exercise control over access to the site and often facilitate access to information. Becoming familiar and cooperative with them is therefore very important phase in the early phase of field work.

In order to do so it is imperative to avoid imposing our ways of looking at the site on the situation and be as collaborative as possible. This stance can democratize the research process to the extent that also understandings of educational staff are considered and given equal consideration in the interpretation of the project results. Relatedly, educational personnel can serve as sounding boards for our ideas and can be given an opportunity to provide input at various points in the project, have input into the planning of the observations and can be consulted for interpretation of the results.

7.3 Explaining our role

Entering the field will require justification of our presence. Although an explicit announcement and explanation of our research to students is necessary (in line with our ethical protocol standards), we will avoid detailed description of research objectives in order to avoid methodological problems. Namely, the danger in telling informants too much about our research goals is in expectancy effect by which students may attempt to behave in line with (or contrary to) our research objectives. For this reason, "shallow cover" explanation most notable for its "sin" of omission might be more appropriate (see Fine and Sandstrom, 1999: 18–21). This means **we will explicitly explain and reaffirm our aims** but will not expanded upon in detail. Shallow cover will make our role explicit, and yet, students will not develop ideas of what we are looking for.

7.4 Approaching students

In our fieldwork we tend to adopt combination of observer (passive observation) and friend role (moderate observation) (see Fine and Sandstrom, 1999: 16 – 17).

The **observer role** (**passive observation**) is defined as the one, where adult is without formal authority and affective relationships. Such a role is used where a record of explicit behaviour is more important than the rhetoric that children give to explain their behaviours. This role is useful, when observing various students' interactions and classroom dynamics. As observers we will be able to provide much behavioural and descriptive data, but without the collection of explanations from the children's point of view.

Passive participant-observation will be adopted where we will be engaged as bystander to social dynamic in school settings; for example, a lesson from the back of a classroom, a school assembly from the back of the hall, a staff meeting or a playground from the side. Initially, we will not be part of the activities and will adopt 'fly on the wall' techniques to observe things as they happen, naturally, as undisturbed by our presence as possible. We should spend a fair amount of preliminary time in the setting so that participants get used to us and our presence.

It has been known, that children and youth may have little or no motivation to allow the observer to learn the social rules by which their group operates. Consequently, it is necessary for us to combine observer role with that of a **friend** (**moderate observation**). This approach is in line with our child-centered approach for it builds on interaction between us and students in the most trusted way possible – without us having any explicit authority role. In the light of age and power differences involved, we cannot completely avoid the authority dimensions, however, we will try to adopt a role appropriate for the contexts, which can set us on the best possible terms with the children. That could for instance be by adopting **"the least-adult role" or "the least-teacher role"** (see Mayeza, 2017). Our task will be to establish positive relationship with relative lack of authority and a lack of sanctioning of the behaviour of children.

Moderate participation will be applied, when we will actively participate in events like school activities, meetings, site visits, and planning sessions without, however, becoming a full member of the school community in question. The central idea of participation is to *personally* experience happenings in conjunction with others by assuming a real role within the group or institution. With moderate participation we will be able to observe dynamics from the closest range as well as monitor our own experiences and thought processes.

Because we are interested in describing the school dynamic and peer interactions in “natural” setting, it is imperative that we minimize any obtrusion. The period of initial observation is crucial in this regard because we as observers must take time to have students get used to our presence, so that with time they act in a way that approaches the way they would act if we were not there. Nevertheless, collection of data in early period is important, not least with regards to our own self-reflection, immediate impression and understanding of the field.

The friend role is helpful to the development of trust, although this trust must be cultivated by the researcher and this type of unique interaction takes time to develop. This is also typical for our child-centred approach, to blend in with the children by developing less paternalistic and more democratic and equivalent relationships with them. This is important, given that children are typically keen to please adults and thus to give socially desirable or confirmatory responses.

In order to do participant observation with children successfully, we must be able to deal with them on a relatively equal footing and also have the ability and desire to listen to them. There are two general techniques that may be employed by us to increase rapport and access. The first is to become a "peer". Becoming a "peer" does not mean that we behave like children or adolescents; useful advice when we will try to be a friend is that we behave as a good friend might, establishing relations of mutuality and respect. The second technique is to employ social rewards and small material gifts to promote acceptance (offering “an engaged and interested ear”, support, companionship, educational expertise, praise, candy).

7.5 Participant observation with 10-13-year-olds

Children at this age are testing the boundaries of proper behaviour, establishing close friendships, and developing sense of self-presentation. Preadolescents have the opportunity to develop their own society outside of the prying eyes of adults. This means that they have a special right and opportunity to decide the way in which they will relate to us. This power means that preadolescents will have a fair degree of authority to shape our role, and we must recognize this.

In work with preadolescents, the sponsorship of a "key informant" (see Fine and Sandstrom, 1999: 50 – 51) may be crucial to learning the ropes and gaining acceptance by a group of informants. One criterion for identifying key informant is that this individual has a central position in the social structure of the group, which implies access to persons and knowledge. One can distinguish between two components of the key informant: that of *sponsor* and that of *source.* It is the both, the ability and willingness to supply the researcher with *information and access* to the group that marks the key informant.

What kind of students would help in this way? Often it is a student who has a sense of security in his or her position of leadership. These children are self-assured in social situations, and this self-confidence allows them to bridge the gap between adult and child. It also leads them to feel secure in their social authority and competence over a friendly, yet ignorant, adult. The key informants may suggest ways how we should act or react (i.e., don't be shocked; don't be too pushy; don't ignore the middle-status group members). This represents something of an inversion of the normal relations between adult and child. It also represents placing trust in an adult, when normally, because of the topics being considered, that trust would be misplaced.

The “key informant” approach may be complemented with the possibilities of the “trusted adult” (friend) role for a group of children, that *has the perspective* of the child as one who is learning from and listening to the children (and not having opinions all the time). In this more “laid back approach” we give the children (as group and as individuals) the opportunity to come and tell and ask and relate to the researcher by their own initiative. It moreover leaves us the opportunity to take a role of curiosity and care for the children’s perspectives and doings, as the “ignorant adult” as mentioned previously.

7.6 Participant observation with 14-17-year-olds

Adolescents are becoming increasingly similar to adults, even though they are adults with rough edges. This does emphasize the fact that the researcher and his or her informant could have a thoroughly equal relationship. The goal of being treated fully as an equal is more possible in this circumstance. Problem that can arise in qualitative research with adolescents results from treating them as "research subjects" rather than people one sincerely wishes to get to know.

The research role is perhaps more delicate when dealing with adolescents than at any other period of childhood, as sensitivity about one's rights and powers are heightened as full adult responsibility nears. When this is coupled with large status differences (as when dealing with lower-class adolescents or those in total institutions), the research relationship can be very fragile. We suggest that a researcher adopts a non-judgmental approach in combination to building trust with informants.

7.7 When and what to observe

In each school we will conduct at least 15 days of combination of passive and moderate participant observation within the three months period of “entering the field” (predictably between October 2019– December 2019). In this period researchers will spend time in schools on a regular basis before conducting any further interviews, to get to know children in spontaneous manner, spending time with them in the school environment including classroom, extracurricular activities, schoolyard, lunchtime and after school, when possible. Researchers may offer help to child informants, including companionship, educational expertise or give small gifts.

Some preliminary observations may be necessary to determine when is best time that specific behaviors can be observed. We simply cannot observe all participants all the time. We must determine

the best times for observing target behaviors and then determine the appropriate amount of data to be collected.

It is estimated that in each school researcher will observe one or two classes, depending on the structure of students; according to research plan at least 5 newly arrived, 5 long-term residents and 5 local children per school are to be included (for interviews). In participant observation we will however observe and make fieldnotes about entire class and dynamics occurring therein. Specifically, we will focus on five key dimensions 1) peer interactions; 2) interactions with school staff; 3) task orientation; 4) teachers' interaction; and 5) reflexive methodology. All these dimensions will be observed in relation to our **main research question and question of child-centred approach to migrant integration.**

Peer Interactions

Peer Sociability: observe the nature of social networking and social relations among students in its broadest sense; observing students positive/negative emotions, behaviours and dynamics with peers, including the tendency to seek/avoid peer interactions, group dynamics, leadership, subordination, social contacts and isolation, the organization of social subgroups (according to ethnicity, gender…). Also observing what identity categories are at play among the students, are they dichotomous, flexible, fluid or solid, etc.

Peer Communication: observe the nature of communication in its broadest sense; observing students (lack of) initiative and maintaining conversation with peers to make needs, emotions, and opinions known (e.g., requesting, commenting, and questioning), verbal and non-verbal communication, (non)violent communication, etc.

Peer Conflict and Assertiveness: observe students' interactions with peers, characterized by tension, resistance, and negativity, latent and more explicit as well as observing peer assertiveness as a dimension, which is opposite to conflict relationship.

Interactions with school staff

Positive Engagement with the school staff: observe the relation of students with school staff in its broader sense; if/how students emotionally connect to the teacher(s) and adults, including seeking/avoiding interactions with them, and using (or not using) them as a secure base etc.

Communication with school staff: observe the nature of communication with school staff in its broadest sense; readiness to communicate, observing if/how students initiate, avoid or maintain conversation with the teacher(s) to make needs, emotions, and opinions known (e.g., requesting, commenting, and questioning), etc.

Conflict and Assertiveness with school staff: observe students' interactions with the teacher(s) and adults, which are characterized by tension, resistance, and negativity as well as observing peer assertiveness as a dimension, which is opposite to conflict relationship.

Task Orientation

Engagement within Tasks: observe if/how students are actively involved in classroom tasks and activities, including the amount of time the student remains focused on any given activity, the level of intensity or enthusiasm displayed, and the proportion of time the child spends on assigned activities.

Self-Reliance: observe if/how students take learning into their own hands, including seeking opportunities rather than passively waiting for teacher direction, and making best use of classroom resources (including the teacher).

Teachers' interaction

Engagement with students: observe how/if teachers interact with students generally and if apply they child-centered approach in classrooms.

Conflict management: observe how/if teachers resolve negative behaviours, appearing in classroom or elsewhere, with an emphasis on conflicts stemming from ethnic, religious, racial background.

Engagement with cultural diversity topics: observe if/how teachers address themes related to multiculturalism and cultural, religious and racial diversity, integration and cultural co-habitation. Also observing what identity categories teachers mention; the ways in which teachers categories students; what identity positions are made available to the students.

Reflexive methodology

Used methods: describing how "useful" from collecting data point of view the method seems to you, describing how students and gate keepers were approached, how we identified informants and what was his/her role, how and why we applied the method as such, etc.

Responses to methods: describing what was good/negative for gaining confidence, how our presence affected behavior of students and educational staff.

Assessment of child-centred approach: describing whether or not we manage to apply child-centred approach, how child-centered approach was ensured and stimulated.

Personal reflection: describing what were the most challenging situations and why, reflection of our expectations, reflection of our personal feeling in relation to particular situation, reflection how and why we influenced the children/adolescence behaviour, reflecting our expectations, what are our positions in intersectional terms – e.g. in what intersections (for instance between gender, ethnicity, age categories) do we occasionally end up in our engagement with the children, how does our intersectional position impact our relations with the children; what can we learn from instances where our position is shaped by multiple identity categories – what does this tell us about the school context, the children understanding of the world etc.

7.8 Ethical concerns

While doing fieldwork research activities in schools we will always follow MiCreate Standard Ethnical Protocol. Our basic ethical principles are based on the best interest of a child and include:

- respecting human dignity and integrity;
- ensuring honesty and transparency towards research subjects;
- respecting individual autonomy and obtaining free and informed consent (as well as assent whenever relevant);
- protecting vulnerable individuals;
- ensuring privacy and confidentiality;
- promoting justice and inclusiveness;
- minimising harm and maximising benefit;
- sharing the benefits with disadvantaged populations, especially if the research is being carried out in developing countries.

The participant observation will involve a range of participants, both adults and children. Children as such represent a vulnerable group. When working with these groups we will follow key principles, which respect children's participation, consent and anonymity for the best interests of all children. despite we will adopt "shallow cover" approach, we will inform students and provide general information about aims and explicitly explain that their participation is voluntary and can withdraw anytime.

Participant observation also involves specific challenges. We might be witness to risky or dangerous behaviour, behaviour outside the rules set by adults. What is our responsibility in that situation? What principles apply to participant observation in which students will be encouraged to behave naturally? If a possibility of serious physical injury exists, we as observers need to intervene, even though we will thereby alter the behaviour of students. In other circumstances that are not physically dangerous but reveal behaviours that are generally condemned (e.g. racism, bullying, theft etc) the degree of direct involvement in directing the behaviour of children should depend on the individual researcher. Sometimes it may be necessary to subordinate the self to the role in the interest of research, but, even so, in dealing with children there will be occasions when one's authority should be used to enforce moral imperatives of the self.

The solution for us, who are embracing the "friend role", is to emphasize that we are not disciplinarian, and to back that up with consistent behaviour. Whenever we should feel to intervene, it should be clear that the intervention is personal, and not because of institutional concerns. Children must be permitted to engage in certain actions and speak certain words that the adult researcher finds distressing. In some instances, we may act in ways that are at least tacitly supportive of these distressing behaviours. In this way, we should avoid for example policing sexually explicit talk. Our suggestion is merely to listen matter-of-factly to the discussion, but not to intervene.

When we discuss adolescent behaviours, which can trail into criminality, the ethical concerns become different, especially in case of drug use, theft, or some other crime. There may be unintended/unexpected/incidental findings that may include indications of criminal activity, children trafficking, abuse, bullying, domestic and other forms of violence. In this case, the researchers will take the principle of **the best interest of the child** as the ultimate criterion for action. In the case of findings outside the scope of the research the researchers of the consortium will also follow national legislation and EU ethical directives and regulations as well.

7.9 Writing fieldnotes

We will make fieldnotes for each observational day separately in line with the template. We will focus on peer group and class dynamics in relation to determinants such as ethnic and cultural background, language proficiency, religion, gender, age etc. With preliminary observation, this may involve writing descriptions of the situation after we leave the field; to record in the field may be too obtrusive. We can use so-called jottings, (scratch notes), which are abbreviated words and phrases to use later to construct full fieldnotes. Data from participant observation will be recorded through daily fieldnotes and, if appropriate, through audio and photographic recordings of events. Useful way to organize our observational notes has been suggested by Corsaro (1981):

- **Field notes (FN)** are behavioural recordings of the participants, group dynamics and their locations, including peer interactions & interactions with school staff, teacher's interaction, task orientations. E.g. description of location, peers, attitudes, responses, dynamics, activities, interactions, specific words, phrases, summaries of conversations, and insider language.

- **Personal notes (PN)** give insight into the observer's personal reaction to specific situations and people, researcher's subjective thoughts, personal reactions, observations. E.g. What was the most difficult part, reflection of your expectations, what was surprising in the fieldwork research? What was it like for you to be doing this research? What felt comfortable for you about being in this site and what felt uncomfortable? In what ways did you connect with informants, and in what ways didn't you? etc.

- **Methodological notes (MN),** description of methods used, theirs success, children's responses to methods, reflection on their capacity to represent child-centered perspective. E.g. how you approached students, what was good/negative for gaining confidence, how your presence affected students' behaviour, how key informant was identified and what was his role, how did you cooperate with gate keepers etc.

- **Theoretical notes (TN)** larger considerations relating to the nature of the research question. 1) How (migrant and local) children perceive/experience the migrant integration processes? 2) how educational staff approach/addresses the migrant integration processes? E.g. What themes can you begin to identify regarding these questions? What questions do you have to help focus your observation on subsequent visits? Can you begin to draw preliminary connections or potential conclusions based on what you learned? Questions about people or behaviours at the site for future investigation etc.

Fieldnotes must be done immediately after leaving the site. Although the researcher may initially think it unnecessary to record observational phenomena that occur repeatedly and are quite obvious, record of all relevant phenomena should be made. It is often the case that what seems obvious and unlikely to be forgotten is often forgotten after hours of observation. In short, records should be kept of what we consider important, no matter how obvious.

7.10 Template for fieldnotes

Researchers Name: _____ Location: _____

Date_____ Name of the School: _____ Class: _____

Field notes (FN): are behavioural recordings of the participants, group dynamics and their locations, including peer interactions & interactions with school staff, teacher's interaction, task orientations. E.g. description of location, peers, attitudes, responses, dynamics, activities, interactions, specific words, phrases, summaries of conversations, and insider language.

Personal notes (PN): researcher's subjective thoughts, personal reactions, observations. E.g. What was the most difficult part, reflection of your expectations, what was surprising in the fieldwork research? What was it like for you to be doing this research? What felt comfortable for you about being in this site and what felt uncomfortable? In what ways did you connect with informants, and in what ways didn't you?

Methodological notes (MN): description of methods used, its success, children's responses to methods, reflection on their capacity to represent child-centered perspective (e.g. how you approached students, what was good/negative for gaining confidence, how your presence affected students' behaviour, how key informant was identified and what was his role, how did you cooperate with gate keepers etc).

Theoretical notes (TN): larger considerations relating to the nature of the research question. 1) How children perceive/experience the processes through which they become a part of society? 2) how educational staff approach/addresses the migrant children integration processes? E.g. questions about people or behaviours at the site for future investigation. What themes can you begin to identify regarding your guiding question? What questions do you have to help focus your observation on subsequent visits? Can you begin to draw preliminary connections or potential conclusions based on what you learned?

7.11 References and further reading

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8. Art-based approaches

This protocol gives an overview of different methods and approaches, based on art and creative ways that can be used to recognize and engage children as participants in the MiCREATE project. Due to the variety of art-based methods and approaches, we acknowledge 'art-based approaches' as an umbrella term, covering several art-based methodologies. The underlying basis for an art-based approach in this 'catalogue' is child centred; thus methods are taken into account in a multi-faceted mode, recognizing the different voices of children, enhancing participation as children are experts and agents in own lives, a focus on the lived experiences of children and that methods are embedded into practice (Clark & Moss, 2001).

Using art-based methods in research processes can offer a different and more varied perspective on the life of children, taking their accounts as face value. Bearing the child centred approach in mind, a child-led research does not automatically give access to an understanding of the life of children or childhood which is superior to other forms of knowledge, but rather a different and broader access to an understanding (Lomax, 2012).

In the processes of interviewing, observing, engaging and other matters, we must be aware that we – in a school context – are in a highly adult structured and adult driven context. The school is based on an adult agenda, framing the children's constraints and possibilities, even in a child-centred approach. Children's way to portray their lives and wellbeing, even with child-centred and art-based approaches, may be restricted by the construction of childhood and migration deployed by teachers, parents, researchers and other adults around them (Holland, Renold, Ross & Hillman, 2010). In continuation hereof, we want to stress that art-based methods and tools not necessarily are empowering by themselves. Depending on the purpose and objective of using art based approaches they can be a tool for children's participation and agency in the research process, as they can serve as an externalizing tool or remedy to overcome language challenges or other personal or structural restrictions.

Before introducing specific art-based methodologies in the catalogue below, we offer some general guidelines as how to integrate and organize art-based methods in fieldwork carried out within WP 5-7.

8.1 Organization of art based research activities

How art-based methodologies are integrated in the fieldwork depends on the competences available among the local project team members. The guiding principles for organizing art-based activities are that

1) The organization of the activities is carried out in a way that helps to stimulate the discussion with the children in both the focus groups and individual interviews, cf. the aims of MiCREATE.
2) The organization of activities should include as much flexibility as possible in order to ensure that the children can influence the content of the activities, and choose which activities they want to take part in, if any

The following template (figure 1) gives an overview of the elements an art-based research design ideally should entail. Moreover, the template visualised how introducing art-based research methods in the fieldwork, on the one hand, help linking group interviews and individual interviews, and, on the other hand, help including children in the research that involves them, positioning them centrally as knowers (cf. Tobia et al. 2012).

Step	Activity	Location	Responsible for activity	Data construction method
1	Introduction to art-based activities (see catalogue below for inspiration)	School	Project team member(s) and children	(Observation)
2	Art-based activities	School or Neighbourhood	Children	Art-based methods handled by children
3*	Presentation of art works	School	Children	Observation done by project team member(s)
4	Focus groups	School	Project team member(s) and groups of children	Interview (and observation)
5	Individual interviews taking art works as a starting point	School or neighbourhood	Project team member(s) and children	Interviewing done by team member(s)

Figure 1. *Step 3 is optional. The sequence of the steps is not fixed and the order may vary across fieldwork interventions.

The following template (figure 2) exemplifies how art-based activities can be implemented in fieldwork. The aim of the template is to stimulate reflection within the local project teams regarding how to implement the art-based activities in their specific fieldwork, taking account of context specific issues such as competences in the project team, time available, school collaboration, etc.

Step	Activity	Location	Responsible for activity	Data construction method
1	Philosophy with Children session on “What is home?” for a group of students, ideally with 10-20 students	School	Project team member 1 and the group of children	Facilitation of dialogue done by project team member no. 1; observation done by project team member two
2	Art-based session 1: "What's your favourite spot" • Introduction to activities	School	Project team member and children	Project member 1 introduces and member 2 takes notes (to use in reflexive methodology)
3	Art-based session 2: Art-project in: Mapping	Neighbour-hood	Children	Pen and pencil, photography,

	Photography Video Etc.			video done by children
4	Art-based session 3: Exhibition of art works	School	Children	Observation done by project team member two
5	Individual interviews based on exhibited art works	School or neighbour-hood	Researcher and Children	Interviewing done by team member(s)

Figure 2. Explanation. Philosophy with Children is form of dialogic teaching, which prioritizes the epistemic status of children at the expense of the adult facilitating the dialogue. Teams may choose other approaches within their competences. It is important to motivate the choice of approaches in the reflexive methodology.

8.2 Catalogue of art-based methodologies3

The following list – or catalogue – of creative methods should be read as a set of examples and 'best practices'. The list of methods is not exhaustive, so each country or research team can add their own methods or alternative versions of methods. The catalogue may serve as an inspiration which methods to choose from, but also may inspire to considerations relevant for the reflexive methodology.

The catalogue is organized as follows: First a short description of the method, followed by examples from research. Hereafter, the main aspects of the methods are summarized. Finally, there will be a hands-on guide how to use the method. As for the latter, how to use the method step-by-step must be considered in each context and in regard to the children's age and preference.

Music/performance

- 'Rap as 'staying safe' – Rap as a mode of enquiry to challenge and explore identities.
- Involving one or more groups of children in writing (visual construction of lyrics), rehearsing and performing a rap.
- Scaffolding the process (the researcher and a music teacher or other school staff with 'rap-experience').
- Performing the rap for an audience.
- Leading a (mini) workshop for other children/adolescents.

Transforming and processing experience, externalizing lived experiences, opening for creativity as transgression and possibilities for multi-identity drafts, the 'rap' can be written in the children's first language and translated before or simultaneously at the performance.

The child participants (selected by school, teacher, researcher or/and volunteering to participate) write, rehearse and performs a rap. In Procter & Hatton (2015) about challenging their 'schooled identities' (but can be on a range of different topics). An artist or person with knowledge about 'rap' should be engaged or part of the inquiry (could be the music teacher at school):

[3] Step-by-step guides are missing in some of the following subsection. In the final version of the protocol, all art-based methods will followed by step-by-step- guides.

'One of the key things that changed the dynamics for the young people was how the artist engaged with them on a personal level. In this project this relationship had a significant impact on what was created and enabled the enthusiasm of the young people to generate different ideas and then work together to develop how these would be represented through the media form chosen. The project developed to the boys leading workshops with other young people at a children's event to finally performing their rap at the 'Staying Safe' adult conference. The conference housed over two hundred delegates, and the boys were applauded for their production of the rap. The boys then led a rap-making workshop with the adults.' (L. Procter & A. Hatton (2015): Producing Visual Research with children: Exploring Power and Meaning Making. In: Stirling & Yamada-Rice, *Visual Methods with Children and Young People*, Palgrave Macmillan).

How to?

Time: 1-2 weeks, depending on the amount of lessons available.

Persons: Teacher, music-teacher/performer and researcher, or researcher only if familiar with music performance or writing of lyrics.

Children/adolescents: The whole class, or participating children. Two or more groups (three to four in each group seems suitable) – depending on the researcher or research team (including teachers).

Aim: Topics, relevant for and chosen by the children/adolescents in relation to the broader aims of MiCREATE. The focus is on children's choices and voices and the possibility to express themselves in creative and 'unschooled' ways.

Step-by-step:

1. Introduction to rap as an art form (teacher, artist or researcher and children/adolescents) and elaboration of the content and form of rap as art-based method; presenting a manual with and for the participating children: How to work, what to work on and what to present.
2. Grouping of the collaborating children/adolescents (exercising sensitivity towards power relations amongst the students, and literacies/academic resources).
3. Using 3-5 lessons on writing lyrics and combine music. The researcher or research time as facilitator, scaffolding the process of groups, writing lyrics.
4. Performance – either performing the rap for the class or (part of) school, or 'performing' by retelling about the rap. No children should be forced to perform in front of other children or adults; 'performing' must be understood in its broadest sense.

'Outcome':

By corporal/bodily and oral support to children's and adolescents' joint language production and creative meaning making, this method can enhance agency for children, who are perceived as less literate in a school context. The method also makes visible how institutional power influences children's engagement and rap-content.

Visual methods – photo-elicitation:

Photo elicitation – meaning children/adolescents taking pictures of a home environment, meaningful places, places of joy, grief, friends, 'safe haven', importance and so on – can provide an interview focus,

show important relationships regarding people or places, promote participant agency, exploration and extended responses. It can potentially also enhance an empowering interaction (the child can choose which photo, what focus etc.) if the photo-elicitation is explicit in how it can support children's voices or perspectives.

The use of visual methods may make it easier to talk about sensitive or uneasy subjects that can be difficult to talk or write about with common talk-based methods (Allen, 2011).

Photo-diary

Creating a 'photo-diary': Example from Allen (2011), researching sexuality with young people aged 17 and 18 and '*how they learned about sexuality in school',* using a 24-exposure disposable camera over a period of six days. The participants gathered and structured the data (photos), showing places and situations the researcher not would have known without the pictures and the individual semi-structured photo-elicitation interviews.

How to?

Time: 1-2 weeks, depending on the topic and the children participants' engagement and possibilities of taking pictures.

Persons: The whole class/classes or the participating children/adolescents and researcher or research team.

Children/adolescents: The participating children/adolescents must be informed about not to take pictures of people. A topic is chosen for the pictures by the Children in collaboration with the researcher(s) and each child gets a disposable camera or uses her own smartphone. If disposable cameras are used, there will be need for instruction in that. Also, the younger children can be asked only to take three pictures a day, preventing 'overload' of pictures on the first days.

Aim: Gathering data in this way may give knowledge on places and situations that the researcher could not have obtained otherwise, and in that way informing the interview. The children are subjects in their own 'research' and can choose what pictures are to be taken and why, thereby participating and voicing their perspective on the topic.

Step-by-step:

1. Present and talk about the method and make sure to get ethical approval of the children to conduct a 'photo-diary' (besides consent from parents, of course). Make a contract about how to use the 'photo-diary': as a private tool between child and researcher as part of the interviews, or as an 'exhibition' of views on the topic to be presented for the class (or in other contexts). Make appointments with the children ahead of the timeline, making sure that they are comfortable with the camera and the task.
2. Meet with the children at least two times during their photography-timeline and talk about how taking pictures works out and if they have a favourite time, place or situation for taking pictures.
3. The last 'meeting': Talk about what pictures are taken and why – and make an 'appointment' for getting back with the processed pictures. Be sure not to wait for too long for this last meeting, no more than a week, preferably days.
4. The child/adolescent chooses pictures for the interview or the exhibition. The interview can be performed as a 'talk-around-the-photos', highlighting the child's/adolescent's POV and voice.

'Outcome': Discovering unknown context, places and relations. Giving the children opportunity to navigate and participate in their own agenda-driven method. Can be used as a main method for understanding children's life, well-being, relations etc. or as part of a photo-elicitation interview.

Photovoice

'Photovoice' project: One example is a project exploring how 6-11-year-old experience 'healthy food' in a community over-represented by obesity. The children where grouped and given a (cheap) digital camera, taking pictures in relation to a collectively agreed on topic each week. Many photos weren't about food but a lot of other places, mostly places being 'safe' or with family. In the interviews, the children talked about food and health as 'parrot talk', repeating the school's discourse of healthy habits. However, the photos illuminated other aspects in regard to food: Safe places and family, and other topics more interesting for the children than healthy food issues. The children took 1000 photos. 100 where chosen collectively and 43 used in an exhibition about the community (and food). The children wrote small stories or headlines to each photo. The projects showed the tacit power of 'expert knowledge' (the school's and teachers' discourse about healthy food) and how the children navigated in and between that knowledge (Sandlin, Szkupinski, Quiroga & Hammerand, 2018)

How to? See above, photo-dairy.

Photo elicitation can be used as a research method to conduct participatory action research. Participants learn to use cameras (disposable or digital) or their cell phone to document, select and share their perspectives on topics, emotions or places.

'*Furthermore, images prompt a different kind of reflection on lived experiences. First, images are able to prompt emotions and thoughts about experiences in ways that narrative alone cannot (Harper, 2002). Furthermore, the act of interpreting an image creates a slower and more critically reflective space within the research process. This reflection may begin with the making of an image: "why is it that I made that photograph, in that moment?" (Liebenberg, 2009). But reflection also happens while participants think about the meaning they attach to images: "what am I seeing in this image?", "why is it important?* […] '*The photovoice process entails the production of photographs by participants so as to facilitate reflection on daily experiences. Images are then collectively interpreted, and finally, resulting findings and emerging knowledge together with identified issues and resources are shared with policy makers with the intent to promote social change.*' (Liebenberg, 2018).

The key is to negotiate what kind of pictures the participant wants to take (on a shared topic, interest, place etc.), and how many photos they should take over a period of time. Also, giving the opportunity to choose and delete photos that participants don't want to share is important. Exploring children's knowledge or emotions about the topic(s) in the interviews can be based on the photos and the narratives surrounding the photos. It may be an issue what kind of tool for photos there is at hand: A disposable camera is easy and affordable, but signals a 'bargain' and provisional tool; a (cheap) digital camera maybe signals worth and value, as a cell phone is at hand all the time, but maybe with more unlimited photos at hand.

Short films:

Children/adolescents may interview each other or provide an auto-interview about their lives, experiences and thoughts. Often a couple of minutes is enough to elucidate important presentations, topics etc. The 'short film' may leave a space for more fleeting and at off-hand insignificant 'small stories'

about life experiences – or future 'imagined worlds'. Questions as 'how does your life look like in 5 years', or 'what would your dream-house be like' etc. could facilitate the narrative approach to short films. The small presentation of lived life or imagined futures can shed light on emotions, wishes and hopes; in the interviews the question of 'why' ('is that you dream-house', 'future plans' etc.) could unfold important aspects of well-being or positioning and agency in and out of school.

The researcher and/or teacher should scaffold the method. Instructions about length and personal information should be discussed and negotiated with the participants.

In Lomax (2012) children in groups collaborated on making a short video on an impoverished neighbourhood:

'a series of interconnected research projects in which children drew on a range of creative visual methods, including participatory video (Kindon, 2003; Lomax et al., 2011; Shaw, 2007); video and photography 'walk-alongs' (Trell & Van Hoven, 2010); video-interviews and photo-portraiture including self-portraiture (Cox, 2011) in order to explore issues of: friendship and migration; spaces and places to play and places they liked and liked less. A total of 13 children (seven boys and six girls) aged 8-12 years took part in the research each of whom, with the exception of two boys, lived within walking distance of the out-of-school play scheme through which they were invited to participate' (Lomax, 2012: 109).

The documenting resulted in a series of creative visual outputs, including:

A four minute film featuring interviews with children and adults about their experiences of living on the estate and making visible their own and other residents' use of the parks and green spaces on the estate.

A series of video-interviews with children and older adults attending, respectively, a lunch and breakfast club, exploring memories and experiences of moving to the estate.

A portfolio of portraits of the children themselves and other residents colour-washed, mounted and displayed on 'photo-trees' for local and national dissemination (Lomax, 2012).

Lomax also points out, that the visual art-based research also revealed how children co-operated, excluded each other, showed dynamics of friendship and dislikes and different positionings.

Using artefacts in interviews:

As part of widening children's agency, artefacts can be used in the interviews – or as an 'object' for drawing, mapping etc., as the main 'object' in the interview or as a mediating tool, bridging sensitive or new topics. Anything can count as an artefact, depending on the purpose or goal for the interview or dialogue with the participant. A poster, produced by the child can be an artefact as can a photo, toy or game. The artefacts can be an entry point for interviewing or be in focus as the child/adolescent explains why and how the artefact is important. In Rowsell (2011) artefacts were used to gather better understanding of children aged 11-14 from different backgrounds. Rowsell asked the participants to bring artefacts they valued. In the interviews she explores why those artefacts where valued: '*The combination of interview talk and interviewee engagement with artefacts offered a window into what a participant valued and why they valued particular material qualities of artefacts'* (Roswell, 2011:341).

The 'draw and write' method:

The child or adolescent can draw the quality or importance of relationships or important tools or artefacts. Children can be handed a sheet with different circles, asking them to put themselves in the middle, and put people/objects/artefacts etc. in the surrounding circles, with the most important persons or valued artefacts closest and least important furthest away. It is strongly recommended to use this method only in the context of individual interviews because the information that comes out of this exercise may be highly sensitive.

Children can draw, write, or make collages in the circles. By making relations visible, the complex map of connectedness and well-being (or the reverse) can be explained or enabling children to 'fit' pieces of importance as a (interchangeable) whole. Other drawing methods could be 'draw your day' or 'draw the best experience you had in the weekend' (or any other point of time). In Eldén (2013) the 'draw and write' method was used to explore how children experienced practical and emotional care giving. The method helps children to narrativize practices, experiences and relationships and can possibly contribute to a more complex picture of relations or values.

Mapping

Using drawing, writing or paper-crafting as a supplemental or main method for elicitating and studying inventive and non-verbal practices, mapping can be used as a multi-purpose method: as a reflective tool, considering topics or emotions; it can be used as navigating tool, showing relations and meanings or it can be used as a processual tool, showing the participants thoughts and 'being in the world' as part of an interview.

Ways to include mapping as a tool:

- Thematic mapping – based on geographic maps, where participants can draw or circle certain areas (places to be, places not to be, favourite spots). Thematic mapping is not exclusively based on geographic maps as participants can draw own maps.
- Pictorial maps – aesthetic purposes and for creative works as part of interviews or instead of interviews (participant can write or record a description of the map).
- Social maps – showing relationships between people, families or/and school-employees and participants.
- Emotional maps – placing 'emoticons' or other semiotic signs on a emotional map. The map can represent a place, relations, a country etc.
- Concept maps – tracing possible links and connections between ideas and understandings.
- Cognitive maps – perception of places and/or places to be acknowledged (cf. Quiroz et al. 2014)

Thus, mapping can show the complexity of relations, thoughts, emotions and artefacts (Newman, 2013) and favour non-verbal methods. Even though, mapping can be used as part of an interview too.

In Gabb, working with younger children, she uses emotional maps, illustrating family life. By using a floor plan over the family's house and giving emoticon stickers to young children, she could study emotional experience and interaction. Using this method in school-context, young children can use emoticons on plans over parts of the school or even their class, pointing at relations and emotions otherwise difficult to express (Gabb, in Kara, 2015).However, it is recommended to use this method only in the context of individual contexts.

Vignettes

Using vignettes (a picture, pictorial art, a brief scene, a comic frame or a short literary sketch), sensitive or difficult topics (discrimination, loneliness, love, loss, belonging etc.) can be discussed or touched upon. Thus, critical or sensitive situations, roles or emotions are externalized by using vignettes. The externalizing makes a critical approach or a description of emotions and relations possible as the personal experience of sensitive or painful issues is 'framed' in the vignettes. The participant can identify and relate to the vignettes without exposing his or hers private and painful issues. As an addition, the participants can move between a first and a third person perspective, as the vignettes opens for both the personal (but not necessary private) and the 'character' or moral stance perspective in the vignettes.

The method favours the exploration of the participants' voices by giving room to talk about sensitive issues without revealing emotions that are not (yet) open for the researcher.

8.3 References and further reading

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9. Collection of autobiographical stories & Narration of Location

9.1 What is collection of autobiographical stories and narration of location and why do we use them?

In the second phase, following the participatory observation and art-based activities, the methodological approach of a collection of autobiographical life stories (Bertaux, 2015) and partly the method of narration of location (Anthias, 1999, 2002) will be applied. These methods were chosen with the aim to empower the children, to give them a **central position** in collecting data, and to locate the children as the main source of information. Subjective perceptions of children will be taken as authentic information and at face value which will enable us to approach the process of integration and well-being from a child-centred perspective.

The method of **collection of autobiographical life stories** is understood as a method of research that delivers "a retrospective account that an actual person makes in prose of his own existence, stressing his individual life and the history of his personality" (Lejeune, 1975). The very nature of life stories brings to the fore subjectivity and individuality as important basic sources of information. The narrative autobiographical method is well-suited for conducting the proposed research particularly since allows special analytical focus on *children's experiences and life history, subjectivity, self-perception, flexibility of identity and possibility of locating various levels of data* such as: concrete family story (what happened, when, why …), interpersonal relations and their reflection, understanding of broad political and economic situation, the interweaving of micro, mezzo and macro data, etc. (Bertaux, 2015).

Additionally, the **narration of location** (Anthias, 1999, 2002) is especially suitable for researching the (cultural) *identity and belonging and* thereby for examining the results of migrant integration processes. The process of integration is a process of transforming the individual's cultural, ethnic, linguistic, etc. identities, therefore, it also addresses the questions of belonging and self-identification. Through the analysis of identity changes, we will be able to observe the process of integration into a new cultural environment. We believe that the method of narration of location is suitable to measure this process because the essence of the method is to 'catch the identity' through narration; it catches the story about where we place ourselves in terms of social categories such as ethnicity, gender, and class at a specific time and space.

9.2 Participants

The collection of autobiographical stories and narration of location methods will involve children from 3 primary (10-13 y/o) and 3 secondary schools (14-17 y/o) per country.

In each school, the interviews in a form of a collection of autobiographical life stories and narration of location will be ideally applied on:

- 5 newly arrived migrant children/young people
- 5 long-term resident migrant children/young people
- 5 local children

The sample in each country should consist of 45 10-13 y/o and 45 14-17 y/o. The sample should consist of 30 newly arrived, 30 long-term resident and 30 local children.

Altogether, 90 interviews will be made per country (repeated interviews count as one interview).

In selecting participants please consider the variety as much as possible and include children of both genders, different cultural, religious, linguistic background, different socio-economic status, etc.

9.3 How to apply collection of autobiographical stories? Some guidelines.

The "power" one usually has as an adult and the researcher is left entirely to the informant - child. We present to the child, in a broad way, what we are interested in, what we are studying, e.g. "*We are interested in your life experiences, what happened in your life*." "*We are interested in you, who you are and how you became who you are?".* We try to avoid precise instructions or attempts to influence what the child should talk about or at what point of his/her life should the narrative begin. If asked, we can say that he/she can choose what he/she finds interesting, important, informative in his life and encourage him/her to express as freely as possible.

He/she is the one who chooses at what point in his/her life he/she will start his life story, how he/she will tell the story, what things, events, people he/she will expose, which ones he/she will skip, and the like. This is important. Namely, when the child determines at which point in his or her life he or she will begin the narrative, or about what he or she talks most of the time, he/she gives meaning to these events, creating a hierarchy of meanings and events in his/her life. We encourage the child to determine the rhythm, scope, and content of the autobiography as much as possible. It is the child who leads the conversation and who overcomes us as an interrogator. In order to stimulate the conversation, we can share our own experience with the child in an unobtrusive way, an opinion, we can raise a question on a topic already started, avoid over-expressing emotions of approval, fear, anger, embarrassment, etc. To sum it up, we avoid expressing emotions/feelings that might be able to encourage or discourage continuation of the narration.

Informants usually want to please the listener, so we must be careful not to influence or encourage the desired behaviour and statements through verbal or non-verbal communication. Special care must be taken not to direct the child to specific answers. The interviews may last different amount of time and should be repeated when possible. Therefore, while a minimum of 1 interview with each child should be implemented, preferably there should be more sessions with each child in order to get.

The length of the conversation (which is being recorded) is adjusted to the well-being and readiness of the child. Above all, the first conversation (if the child speaks freely and has a lot to say) can take place as spontaneously and unstructured as possible. In the following conversations, we can encourage the child to talk about other topics if he/she wishes or feels like.

Some of the topics that will be covered by interviews:

1) Everyday life of a child
2) Relations with peers, friends
3) Family and family life
4) Everyday life in school
5) Pre-migration period
6) Post-migration period
7) Multiculturality, xenophobia and racism

9.4 Methodological advantages of the Collection of autobiographical life stories

The justification for choosing an autobiographical approach as a cognitive instrument can be illustrated by the main characteristics and advantages of this narrative research technique, the most important of which are: a holistic approach, historicity, and contextual orientation, subjectivity and consideration of the individual's self-perception, flexibility, and ability to locate different levels of data

The *holistic orientation* of the autobiographical approach is one of the fundamental features that distinguish qualitative research from the quantitative study of individual entities. In the latter approach, the researcher's attention is focused mainly on measuring the connections and relationships between individual and context-isolated variables, often neglecting the connection of the studied segments with the broader context. The holism of autobiographies assumes that the findings are integrated into a meaningful whole and evaluated through the spectrum of the wider social, political, and economic context (Moon, 1998).

Historicity and contextuality, characteristics that closely relate to the above-mentioned holistic approach, make it possible to consider the relevant socio-historical context within which the subject of study is situated. Everyone is linked to the immediate environment. It is this "everyday" environment that represents an individual's primary social context, and failure to follow this dimension would prevent the research act itself from accessing comprehensive information and a deeper understanding of the phenomenon under study. The contextual orientation of autobiographies thus enables the inclusion of significant others, local community, economic and political situation, etc. into a research and analytical act. In addition, the inclusion and consideration of the temporal dimension (i.e., historicity) enable us to understand the process and the changing nature of social facts (Bertaux, 1981; De Camargo, 1981).

Contextualism enables obtaining relevant information about the child's family and social networks, reasons for moving, country of origin and country of arrival, the presence of ethnic stereotypes and prejudices, potential nationalisms and ethnic intolerance, etc.; the historical dimension, however, provides insight into changes (of identity, belonging, opinions, attitudes …) and the connection of these changes with the circumstances of social life.

The question of *subjectivity* is central of the autobiographical method. The active involvement of the subject in the research/cognitive process provides access to privileged dimensions of human reality that cannot be achieved through other approaches (e.g. information about life experiences, individual choices, conscious actions, and interpretations of them) (Burgos, 1989). Autobiographies have proven to be a particularly effective instrument for exploring the meanings that surround everyday experiences, meanings, and human interpretations of ourselves.

The autobiographical method, as the central source of information, highlights the informant - an individual with the exclusive experience of a migrant's life. Only the owner of this direct experience and the resulting behaviour can provide such comprehensive and direct information on the phenomenon of research interest (i.e. migration) that would remain hidden and disregarded without the active involvement of the subject in the research and cognitive act.

The *flexibility* of the autobiographical method allows us to face both the expected and the unexpected (Thompson, 1981). If quantitative approaches are immobilized by the set structure (questions determine the hypothesis at the beginning), the autobiographical approach confronts us with the process of continually testing and reformulating hypotheses. The obtained findings lead to new questions, and we turn to both old and new informants, through which we verify and supplement the reality of the acquired behaviour. The flexibility of the autobiographical approach is reflected in the

cyclical nature of research, with testing and reformulation of hypotheses being completed once sociological behaviour "both theoretical and derived from social reality" is reached (Thompson, 1981).

Because of this feature, the method of autobiographies is placed among Grounded theories. Despite the carefully set theoretical and hypothetical guidelines for approaching the subject of study with the autobiographical method, we are confronted with the finding that surprises us and we couldn't anticipate them. The flexible nature of the autobiographical narrative thus provides us with answers that our social imagination could not predict.

The importance that autobiographies attach to human self-interpretation and self-perception, and to place the informant and their narrative in a position that is perceived to be superior to previously outlined hypotheses and research guidelines, proves that this method is particularly suited to capture experiences of "deprivileged" and "silent" (Stanley, 1992; Evans, 1993). The autobiographies thus facilitate and promote the expressive power of racial, sexual, ethnic marginalized and stigmatized groups. It has also proved particularly effective in exploring family (moral and value) microclimates and subtle interpersonal relationships in primary groups (Thompson, 1981).

9.5 (Ethnic and cultural) Identity of observed children

In trying to understand the process of establishing and changing of the (ethnic and cultural) identity of children, we will, while applying the method of collection of autobiographical stories, use a methodological approach which Anthias (2002) described as the narration of location. Both approaches are intertwining quite simultaneously, the specific of the narration of location can be thus express shortly in the following question

"**How and what did you become?"**

The essence of the narration of location is the "capture of identity" through the narrative – capturing a story about how we position ourselves in terms of social categories of ethnicity, gender, class, etc. at a specific time and space. The story I was looking for is the story of how and with whom we identify, including wider social practices and their interpretation. The collected narratives are therefore the stories of creative searching for meaning and self. The self-narrative always includes a narrative about others, and therefore a narrative about social interactions and how they influence the building of identity. Informers' stories always included a wider social context and different levels of information from socio-historical to intimate, personal, and family narratives. The story of location, positioning, and attitude towards affiliation is always the story of dislocation, change, and planting. This is even more important when studying the effects of migration on changes of (ethnic, cultural) identities since migration always means relocation and dislocation at multiple levels: personal, cultural, and structural. The method gives special attention to spatial and contextual dimensions, and sees the process of identity building, and not identity, as an individual's property. The question "**Who are you?**" is replaced by the question "**How and what did you become?**". The concept of identity is formed as a process and no longer as a person's description.

While applying the research, we must consider the fact that **identity as such is a highly disputed concept**, especially in relation to ethnic/cultural identity. Some authors (Brubaker & Cooper 2000; Anthias 2002; Pajnik 2011) expose scepticism in the heuristic and analytical value of *identity*. Moreover, "identity is too ambiguous, too torn between 'hard' and 'soft' meanings, essentialist connotations and constructivist qualifiers, to serve well the demands of social analysis" (Brubaker & Cooper 2000: 2).

Besides, this is reintroducing essentialism through the back door, and shifting attention away from context, meaning and practice (ibid.). To partially circumvent the negative aspects of the "identity concept", we will **move away from perceiving identity as an "existing state" and focus on the process of shaping and transforming identity and feelings of belonging.**

Although we are advocating a social constructionist approach to identity, we also agree that in the same way that social constructionists criticized essentialist frameworks in the study of identity formation, postmodern theorists have been rightfully critical of social constructionists for lacking a thorough analysis of variations within categories of identity such as race, class, and gender (García 2004). From this perspective, social constructionists do not address the dynamic of differences and a "matrix of domination" to explain the structural and ideological conditions that play a contributing role in ethnic identity construction (Zinn & Thornton Dill in García 2004: 25). To analyse the process of identity formation and construction, we will, as suggested by García (ibid.), use the concept "palimpsest of identity" in viewing a social constructionist's perspective through a postmodern lens.

Even if we advocate a social constructivist and post-structuralist view of identity as situational, variable, adaptable and fluid (Giddens 1991; Beck 1992; Brubaker & Cooper 2000), as well as the views of authors of hybridized (Bhabha 1990, 1996), transcultural (Welsch 1995) and mixed ethnic identities (Sedmak 2011b; Sedmak and Zadel 2015), according to which we are all more or less culturally and ethnically mixed, at the same time we must not overlook the essentialism and essentialist practices that are true and real in their consequences in the practices of everyday life (Brubaker & Cooper 2000; Pajnik 2011). Here we must be especially aware, as exposed by Pajnik (2011), about unequal power relations and existent structural relations in the society which are influencing ethnic self-identification. Your self-perception as Slovenian can thus easily run along with the perception of broader society or the legislative system and official census which label you as "migrant" and "non-Slovenian". Further, as Brubaker & Cooper (2000) remind us, there is a discrepancy between theory and practice. Speaking to ordinary people about their identity reveals that the practice of essentialism appears very real and is perpetuated both by in-group and out-group members.

9.6 Coding, analysis and interpretation

In order to analyses and interpret data each interview should be coded in a following way:

Interview I:
- date of conducted interview and duration (20.11.2019; 95 min)
- "name/nickname"
- gender
- age
- country of birth
- time of arrival in Slovenia
- school

	VARIABLE	CITATIONS	DESCRIPTION
1	Family and relatives		
2	Early childhood		
3	General Life in home country		
4	Premigration period		
5	Reason for migration		
6	Experiences related to migration (ex.travel, life on the move)		
7	Coming in a new country		
8	Early days, months in a new country		
9	Language issues		
10	Other challenges, problems		
11	Experiences of inclusion in school		
12	General life		
13	Everyday life in school (peer relation, role of teachers etc.)		
14	Integration/assimilation/acculturation process in school		
15	Integration/assimilation/acculturation in local community		
16	Identity, belonging, role of ethnic group, religion community		
17	Well-being, health issues, mental and psychical health, trauma		
18	Friends and social network		
19	Leisure time, activities		
20	Aspiration, desires		
21	Attitudes toward multiculturalism, migration, etc.		
22.	Xenophobia, interethnic conflict racism, nationalism (institutional and interpersonal)		
23.	Socio-economic status		
Etc. add			

(*Method of classification as a basis for further analysis and comparation is summarized and adapted according to B. Mesec, 1998:137)*

Before the analysis you will receive the report template which will be based on the above coding. Some of the codes will be merged.

In order to fulfil the tasks within WP9 (Crosscutting and comparative analysis successfully while collecting and analysing the autobiographical stories please put additional attention on following determinants: **age, gender, ethnicity, religion, socioeconomic status and legal status.**

9.7. References and further reading

Anthias, Floya (2002). Where do I belong? Narrating Collective Identity and Translocational Positionality. Ethnicity 2/4: 491–514.

Bertaux, Daniel (ed.) (1981). Biography and Society: The Life History Approach in the Social Science. Beverly Hills, London: Sage.

Mesec, Blaž (1998). Uvod v kvalitativno raziskovanje v socialnem delu (Introduction to the qualitative research in social work). Ljubljana. Visoka šola za socialno delo.